

Replacement for paper?

Touted to replace paper as a note taking device, the NoteSlate tablet would hit the stores by June 2011 for \$99

Samsung new Galaxy series ad

Samsung has released a three minute video showing who all should be using these phones

The titans meet Nokia and Microsoft join hands...

It's official now, Nokia is partnering with Microsoft to make Windows Phone 7 its "principal smart phone strategy," and will together "combine assets and develop innovative mobile products on an unprecedented scale."

A strongly worded open letter written by both Elop and Ballmer, as well as a press release from the companies, outlined the strategic alliance's intent, and added that Microsoft services and products like Bing, Xbox Live, and Office, as well as Nokia offerings like Ovi Maps, will also be part of "broad strategic partnership".

Nokia would help drive the future of Windows Phone, innovating on top of the platform, especially in areas such as



imaging and language support, as well as maps. Other collaborations between the two include Bing for Nokia search services, Microsoft adCenter Nokia's advertisement services, and Ovi Maps for Microsoft mapping services. Nokia and Microsoft will apparently collaborate on joint marketing initiatives as well, sharing a development roadmap.

While this doesn't exactly signal the end of MeeGo or even Symbian, Nokia has stressed the continued importance of Qt as the unified development framework for these two platforms, and Microsoft's free Windows Phone Developer Tools will be used for upcoming Nokia Windows Phone devices. Microsoft has also offered

"guidance" to developers interested in porting their apps for WP7, making evident no Qt tie-in to WP7 APIs. The integration, or dissolution, of the Ovi Store into the Microsoft Marketplace might just hold some interesting opportunities for developers, effects we are bound to start seeing soon.

A letter to Nokia app developers assured them of a continued future for the Qt-based platforms, with news of plans to sell "around 150 million more Symbian devices", and of the first MeeGo-related open source device shipping later this year.

While the world is wondering how everything will pan out, of immediate consequence - Intel is not happy, and nor are the Qt developers. 

Galaxy S II and Galaxy Tab II Samsung takes the next step

As promised, Samsung unveiled the official successor to the Galaxy S - the Galaxy S II (I9100) - in a pre-MWC announcement. It is scheduled to release in parts of Europe and Asia by March, and global availability should follow soon after.

Featuring the Super AMOLED Plus - the Galaxy S II has a 4.3-inch Gorilla Glass covered screen (800x480) that Samsung assures the world is much better than the IPS



panel (or Retina Display) of the iPhone 4. The phone's screen bezel is also extremely thin when compared to the massive display.

Also new, is the use of a dual-core CPU, assumed to be one of Samsung's Orion SoC processors, which recently received the Exynos branding. It also has a solid 1GB of RAM onboard.

At 8.49 mm, it is also making headlines as the thinnest smart phone in the world. The Galaxy S II runs Gingerbread, and touts a new and

improved UI customisation - TouchWiz 4.0. The new interface will also have four new hubs, called Reader, Game, Music, and Social, for specialised UI interactions.

Samsung has also put in some new security features, including remote lock, remote wipe, remote app shutdown, and remote locator. It has an 8 MP camera that's capable of 1080p video recording, and, also sports a 2 MP front-facing camera for video calling.

The Samsung Galaxy Tab II was also unveiled in the pre-MWC announcement, with few new details. The Galaxy Tab II runs Android 3.0 (Hon-



eycomb). It has a 10.1-inch screen size (1280x800 pixel - WXGA resolution), offering a new form factor for those not excited by the original 7-inch Galaxy Tab.

Other features unveiled include an 8 MP rear-facing camera capable of 1080p HD video capture, a 2MP front-facing camera for video-calling, stereo speakers, a width of 10.9 mm, and encoding/decoding 1080p HD video onboard. 